

SAMPLE ISSUE · Real Chattanooga places & people; specific “this week” details are illustrative.

INDEPENDENT · READER-FUNDED · MADE IN CHATTANOOGA

The Scenic City Insider

Your weekly field guide to the people building Chattanooga.

VOL. 1 · NO. 1 · WEDNESDAY, JUNE 24, 2026

Morning, Scenic City.

Welcome to the new shape of the Insider — same promise (**we work for you, not advertisers**), now with a few standing features I think you'll grow to love. This week: a shop you've driven past a hundred times, the debut of a section about who can *actually* get in the door, and one very good reason to set a Sunday alarm.

Let's go.

WHAT'S NEW AROUND TOWN

Openings, closings, and the things changing before anyone else says so.

↗ **Now open** — **Creature Comforts Beer Garden.** The beloved Athens, GA brewery just planted its first Tennessee flag in “The Shed,” a reborn foundry building in the new Foundries District by the Lookouts' ballpark. A permanent riverfront spot is coming next door.

↗ **Also new** — **Stone Age Korean BBQ, Hot Pot & Sushi** brought all-you-can-eat tabletop grilling to the Gunbarrel corridor — three formats under one roof for the night nobody can agree on dinner.

Just Licensed (members hear it first): a coffee-and-bakery just filed paperwork for a downtown storefront on Georgia Ave. We're confirming the name and opening date — **members get it the moment we do.** Not a member yet? That's the perk.

Heard about an opening or a closing before we did? **Hit reply** — you're our best reporters.

HIDDEN GEMS

The shop at the halfway point

You've passed it a hundred times heading up Lookout. **Mountain Memories** has sat on Scenic Highway since 1928 — back when it was the “Halfway Shop,” where horses watered halfway up the mountain. Behind the counter is **Jeanne Crawford**, granddaughter of **Leo Lambert**, the man who discovered Ruby Falls that very same year.

Tour buses blow right past on their way to the big attractions. Don't. Stop in, and ask her about the carriage days — she tells the stories nobody else stops to hear. That's the whole point of this section.

THE OPEN DOOR • NEW

Because “is it good?” isn't the only question

A section we'll run all year. Can you get in with a wheelchair? Will it work for a kid who's overstimulated by noise? Is there anything worth ordering if you don't drink? We'll answer those, one place at a time — and we need your help.

This week, an easy win: Coolidge Park & the Tennessee Riverwalk on the North Shore — flat, paved, stroller- and wheelchair-friendly, and free, with the antique carousel and the splash fountain. A genuinely come-as-you-are morning for every body.

Where does Chattanooga get access *right*? Reply and nominate a spot — you'll shape this section.

THE STANDING INVITATION

Do this one thing this week

Not a calendar. One assignment, and the why.

Sunday, go to the **Chattanooga Market** at First Horizon Pavilion (11–4). Skip breakfast. Walk the whole thing once before you buy a single thing — then go back for the one you couldn't stop thinking about. It's the beating heart of “made here,” now in its 26th season, and half the makers we'll feature this year start at a booth just like these.

YOU TOLD US

Your replies sent me to **Niedlov's** for the sourdough (you were right), **Mad Priest** for a cortado, and into a surprisingly heated debate about the best patio downtown. Keep them coming — the best of this newsletter comes from you.

We don't take ads, and we never will. The Insider works for its readers — so two small asks: **forward this** to one person who loves this city, and **reply** with a person or place I should meet.

Want the “Just Licensed” intel before the city does — plus the full archive?

Become a member (\$8/mo). *It's how an independent guide to Chattanooga stays independent.*

Yours in the Scenic City,

[Your Name]

Founder & Insider-in-Chief

The Scenic City Insider

Independent. Reader-funded. Made in Chattanooga.

No ads. No sponsorships. Just us and you.

Written by [Your Name] in Chattanooga, TN.

[Update preferences](#) · [Unsubscribe](#)